

transistors to today's super and quantum computers. Everybody today will agree that computers and electronics have forever changed our way of life. There are electronic systems and integrated chips in everything we are using in our day-to-day life activities. Today, when we are all surrounded with smart electronic equipment, working as per our instructions and desires, and proving to be as good as the sixth sense, we can always expect some encounter with some supernatural phenomena. **Scientist Nikola Tesla also said not to dismiss ideas that appear supernatural or not of science as Physics, as these extend beyond what is scientifically known today.**

The future will show that what we now call occult or supernatural is based on a science not yet developed, but whose infant steps are being taken as we speak. In the past, scientists thought that electricity and electronics could be an important link between our world and the world of the dead—even Nikola Tesla believed that radio could be a means of communication with spirits. Other scientists too thought that electricity could give life to the dead, and they believed that spasms with shocks were attempts of bodies to return to life. It is expected that with the help of smart electronics instrumentation, within the next few years, the fact of eternity of existence will have advanced from the realm of questioning to the realm of certainty.

Over the years of technological developments, we have at our disposal adequate electronics-based technical devices to test facts by experimentation. Many modern-day conveniences are electronic in nature, and such devices as cellphones, computers, stereos and TVs are not only useful, these are also testaments to the triumph of science and technology.

Ingenuity and reason have given us capabilities far beyond anything that we have naturally. Yet, imagina-



K2 EMF Meter Duo 2 (K-II ghost meters) (Credit: www.amazon.in)

tion connects the fruits of that labour with the supernatural. There are two prominent ways in which the supernatural is connected to electronics. First, there is a claimed connection between electromagnetism and ghosts. Ghost hunters claim that ghosts create electromagnetic radiation or consist of electromagnetic energy. Repeated claims have been made on the show *Ghost Hunters*.

Second, a direct connection between electronic devices and the supernatural is often asserted. The most common form is the so-called electronic voice phenomena (EVP). This occurs when individuals claim that supernatural entities, especially spirits of the departed, communicate through static in electronic devices.

With no universally-accepted methods of investigating the paranormal, beliefs of investigators can greatly influence the outcomes of their own investigations. Many procedures to detect paranormal activities have been tested using dowsing rods, electronic voice recorders, energy detectors, video cameras, electromagnetic field meters, Geiger counters and so on.

Though none of the methods to track paranormal occurrences have been scientifically proven so far

and evidences provided are scientifically debated, yet all investigators assert about the success of their method.

However, in pursuit of scientifically-verifiable evidence, advanced tools and electronics have been employed. **The art of recording EVP is one of the most widely-accepted methods of collecting evidence. Given below are some of the methods for investigating paranormal events.**

Electronic voice phenomena. In the field of ghost- and spirit-hunting, EVP technology specifies sounds found on electronic recordings, which are interpreted as spirit voices. Parapsychologist Konstantin Raudive (1909-1974, Russia), who popularised the idea in the 1970s, described EVP as

typically brief, usually the length of a word or short phrase.

Supports always consider EVP to be a form of paranormal occurrences often found in recordings with static or other background noise. However, scientists regard it as a form of auditory pareidolia phenomenon and a pseudoscience. Routine explanation for EVP includes apophenia (that is, perceiving patterns in random information), equipment artefacts and hoaxes.

Paranormal energy detectors. The field of electronics has given detectors of various phenomena such as psycho-energy detectors, ion detectors, magnetic field oscillator detectors, electric charge detectors, ion detectors, etc.

An electronic device called ghost detector (ghost meter), which contains a circuit that can detect oscillations in the magnetic field—defying the thinking that paranormals are caused by ghosts—is just concentration of ions in the air. Commercial ghost detectors are easily available in the market, and these are nothing more than electromagnetic field (EMF) meters, which are capable of measuring EMFs.

Instrumental trans-communication. Electronic equipment not